

The art of misleading

They'll try their best but you don't budge

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You all have been reading my opinions about the stuff that shows up at the Digit Test Centre for years now. Everything from smartphones to speakers to TVs has been in the firing line once I have played around with them and learnt about the ways in which the manufacturers were trying to play on words and sell them to you.

This month, my fellow writers at the Digit Test Centre also mustered enough courage to talk about all the jargon and the things that manufacturers typically market. Well, assuming that you all read through their articles before landing up here, let me get started. First things first, what is it with manufacturers taking a dig at their competitors and then going on to do the same thing?

If you do not remember, then let me remind you. Remember when a company named after a fruit decided to drop the headphone jack from their phones without any reason? Well, we all know it was to promote the sale of their newly launched "greatest ever" TWS earbuds. I'll talk about that later. But, yeah, you know what I am talking about, right? At that time, their biggest competitors in the smartphone industry called them out on their move.

A couple of years later, the manufacturer who had called out the fruit company for removing the headphone jack from their phone removed it themselves. GUESS WHY? They were launching a new pair of TWS earbuds. It's not like they came up with the earbuds in a jiffy. Years of R&D must have gone into making those earbuds what they were. And, the marketing bros of that company would have seen this move coming. So, why go out and

create a hypocrite out of your own self?! It doesn't stop there. When the fruit company started shipping their phones without a charging adapter to make their products more "environmentally friendly", their competitors called them out on that. Well, guess what, folks? The competitor did the same darn thing a couple of years later. I am sure the execs at the brand HQ are patting themselves on the back for being fashionably late to the party.



When calling out the first ones who were at the 'f the consumers' wallet gala', did they not know that they will be attending as well? I simply don't get it. First of all, one company decides to take away stuff from the consumers. Then the others mock them. And, before you know it, that move is a trend now!

All of this is then buried under a barrage of marketing jargon, and given the attention spans we have, we forget the initial cause of the move.

I mean, does it make any sense to be supplying a USB-A to a proprietary connector cable when you are packing the charging bricks with the phone. And then, when you decide that you want to stop supplying the bricks, swap out the cable with a USB-C to a proprietary

connector cable. Then, when it comes to marketing, they will say that it was for the betterment of the environment because most people already own charging bricks. For years you have been supplying charging bricks with USB-A outputs, so how are they supposed to work with the new cables that are USB-C to some age-old connector which governments are now forcing you to replace?!

Then come the presentations and keynote events of these products where all this talking takes place. I understand that you want to blind the consumers before the launch of a product by shining beams of marketing terms in their eyes so that by the time they recover, they are already the owners of a not-so-great product. But guess what!

I am here wearing sunglasses, and when you are trying to sneak in all the hyped sales, I already know what your next move will be. All that ain't getting past me.

The unlabelled graphs, the footage shot with the

phones hooked up with a thousand other accessories being marketed as something you will be able to reproduce with the phone just after taking it right out of the box. It is all that we are keeping an eye out for, and as much as possible, we will try to keep it away from reaching our readers.

Before I pop a vein or get booted off this place, there's only one thing that I'd like to say to all of you reading this. Go buy whatever you want, and splurge all your money on getting a yearly smartphone upgrade if you want. But just be aware of the dark void you are walking into. Because if you miss, you will trip and fall face-first into a world where you will be leached off of all the money and geekiness that you have. **d**